Terje Lafton

Senior Platform Engineer

GitHub | terje@lafton.io | +47 419 00 298

Experience

Intility

Senior Platform Engineer Aug 2022 - Present

Returned to the Intility network team, working mostly on Azure. First project was a PoC for Azure Virtual WAN to replace per-customer on-prem VPN tunnels, built first in Terraform, then rebuilt with Crossplane.

Built a custom Crossplane Provider using gNMI and YANG to drive per-customer configuration across the core network from Kubernetes resources, with a frontend on top.

Built a 2.0 version: a custom Kubernetes Operator in Go (replacing Crossplane), a NetBox plugin as a low-level frontend, a gRPC caching proxy that dropped router hits from thousands per second to near zero, and OpenTelemetry instrumentation with Logfire.

Deployed across nine clusters on Intility's Kubernetes platform: a management cluster with Argo and Kargo, plus redundant pairs for lab, staging, preprod, and prod.

Named in the Crossplane v1.16 release blog post for a community proposal to change how resource statuses are handled in the Provider framework (PR 5453).

Oda

Software Developer Jan 2022 - Jun 2022

Worked on the network and sites team during Oda's European expansion. The team handled both existing facilities and new locations. Replaced the Meraki setup with Cisco SDWAN, learning the platform and testing on routers in the facilities. Wrote Python to populate NetBox from operational systems, since documentation was minimal and scattered. The longer-term plan was to automate more of how new facilities are deployed.

Intility

Senior Engineer Sep 2020 - Dec 2021

With more seniority, work shifted from operational cases to project work and training newer engineers joining the network team. Responsible for the software side of Intility's Cisco ACI setup, building Python tooling and APIs to automate tenant operations (creating APs, EPGs, and contracts) and fabric provisioning (new leaves and their port configurations). Python became a daily tool, with some Ansible work too.

Engineer Mar 2016 - Aug 2020

Started in Intility's IT support function, as second-line support since Intility had no first-line. Took the CCNA and moved into the Network Services NOC, working on Cisco core and customer networks across multiple data centres serving thousands of customers, including site-to-site VPNs between Intility's private cloud and customer Azure environments.

Norges Idrettsforbund

Apprentice/IT Support Technician Aug 2013 - Feb 2016

Two-year apprenticeship: first-line phone support for in-house services used by 1M+ members, then on-site desk supporting sports federations and regional offices. Stayed on after the apprenticeship to lead the desk and train new apprentices.

Skills

Kubernetes: Custom Operators, Crossplane, Argo, Kargo, Openshift
Programming: Go, gRPC, Python
Networking: gNMI, YANG, NetBox, Cisco (XR, CML, Meraki, SDWAN), Palo Alto
Cloud: Azure, Terraform
Observability: OpenTelemetry, Logfire
Languages: Fluent Norwegian, Fluent English

Certifications

Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) Aug 2017 - Jun 2020

Talks

From Terraform to Crossplane Intility Developer Day, 2024

Reliability issues we ran into automating Terraform through CI/CD pipelines, with the broader point that automating a CLI tool isn't always a good idea. Then on to Crossplane: what we built with it, the value of a Kubernetes-style control plane, and the reconciler pattern you get for free.

Education

Hønefoss Videregående

IKT Servicefag Aug 2010 - Jun 2013